NLD-led government, this may lead to a change in legislative priorities, and potentially to new textual patterns in the making of law. While I have only focused on laws passed by the Union Parliament, as region and state parliaments pass more laws these will also need to be studied.

The real or perceived threat of violence and conflict, as Cover noted, will continue to justify the existence of law. This is also the case in Myanmar, whether it is institutional conflict between branches of government, conflict between different interest groups on economic reforms, or conflict between the state and society on social reforms. The area of law reform likely to undergo significant change in the immediate future is economic and business reform. There are a number of bills being debated or drafted, including amendments to update and revise the Company Act 1914 (Tun 2014); as well as laws passed recently that will need to be implemented, such as the Competition Law and the Arbitration Law. These laws will have an impact on opportunities for foreign investment, as well as how foreign investment is managed in terms of benefits to local communities. Law can be seen as setting the framework within which expectations are managed and potential conflict between different interest groups controlled.

How then should we understand the recent spate of law reform activities since 2011 in Myanmar, and where it is headed? I suggest that the value of analysing law through its relation to violence and conflict is that it promotes awareness of the need for greater caution in law reform and responsiveness to new tensions caused by legal change. This is not to suggest all conflict is negative, but the potential for law to legitimate violence is real. Such awareness would temper the unrealistic expectations that the solution to Myanmar's issues is simply to legislate reform.

Notes

1 Up to 2013, the volumes of Myanmar Laws published by the Office of the Attorney General include 22 volumes in Burmese, and 20 volumes in English.
2 Law Relating to Pyithu Hluttaw No 12/2010; Law Relating to the Pyidaungsu Hluttaw No 11/2010; Law Relating to the Amyotha Hluttaw No 13/2010; there have been several amendments to these laws since then.
3 Law Amending the Union of Myanmar Constitution No 45/2015.
4 Law Relating to the State/Region Government Law No 16/2010.
5 Union Election Commission Law No 1/2010.
6 Region and State Hluttaw Election Law No 5/2010, Law Amending the Region